COMPLETE UNIT

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Scholar: ____________________

Class: ____________________

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _________

Level	Emerging (1-2)	Emerging+ (3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)

Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: How much progress did the Romans make in public health?			
L2: Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?			
L3: To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?			
L4: How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?			
L5: Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?			
L6: Assessment: Roman Public Health			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: How much progress did the Romans make in public health?

(See Textbook Page 3)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Describe the simple, practical sanitation methods used by Iron Age Britons.
- ☐ Explain how Roman engineers introduced revolutionary sanitation technology.
- ☐ Evaluate the significance of Roman bathhouses and latrines for public health.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

What does AD stand for in historical dates?

What century is the year 1066 in?

Which ancient empire conquered Britain and built Hadrian's Wall?

What does the word 'Sanitation' mean?

What is a primary source?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

cesspit | conduit | latrine

The Romans built massive aqueducts that acted as a [. . . . .] for fresh water. For waste, they used a [. . . . .] or went to a communal [. . . . .] where water flushed the waste away.

Q1. Identify how Iron Age communities managed their waste.

Q2. Describe the purpose of Roman conduits and aqueducts.

Q3. How does this source demonstrate both the advancements and limitations of Roman public health?

Q4. Based on what you have learned about Roman sanitation, why do you think a wealthy palace like Fishbourne would have its own private bathhouse and hypocaust system, while ordinary Romano-British people did not?

Q5. How does the archaeological evidence at Fishbourne support the idea that elite Romans valued hygiene and comfort?

Q6. Explain how bathhouses and latrines improved public health in Roman towns.

Q7. According to Seneca, what does this source reveal about the social and commercial atmosphere inside a Roman bathhouse?

Q8. Evaluate the impact of the Roman withdrawal on Britain's sanitation.

Pair & Share Activity

Q9. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why would the Romans spend so much money on public health?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

Simon Schama *argues: "The Romans were the first to provide their citizens with the basic requirements of public health. Rather than just building spectacular temples, they poured staggering amounts of money, engineering brilliance, and state resources into aqueducts, public bathhouses, and flushing latrines. It was not merely about hygiene, but about Roman identity; to be 'Roman' meant participating in the civilized, communal bathing culture that separated them from the so-called 'barbarians'. However, we must be careful not to overstate this progress: while the wealthy enjoyed luxurious private hypocausts, the vast* *majority of ordinary citizens still lived in crowded, smoke-filled insulae, sharing public latrines that were breeding grounds for intestinal parasites."*

Q10. According to Schama, was Roman public health purely about stopping disease, or was there another motivation?

General Notes

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention aqueducts.
- Mention public baths.

Q11. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how the Romans tried to keep their towns clean.

L2: Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?

(See Textbook Page 7)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Describe the simple cesspits used by peasants in rural Medieval villages.
- [ ] Explain why Medieval monasteries built complex water systems.
- [ ] Evaluate the role of gongfermers and night-work in medieval towns.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

How did the Romans transport massive amounts of fresh water?

What did the Romans use to flush their public toilets?

Why did the Roman army need to stay healthy?

What did the Romans build in their forts to treat sick soldiers?

Did the Romans understand bacteria?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

gongfermer | miasma | monastery | cesspit | privy

Your Sentence:

Q1. Identify the main method of waste disposal in medieval villages like Wharram Percy.

Q2. Describe the sanitation facilities found in medieval monasteries like Canterbury Priory.

Q3. What does this highly detailed plumbing plan suggest about the role of monasteries in preserving public health during the Medieval era?

Q4. How does the water management system at Titchfield Abbey support the idea that monasteries were much healthier places to live than Medieval towns?

Q5. Explain why overcrowded medieval towns faced a filtration crisis.

Q6. Explain the role of gongfermers in medieval towns.

Q7. Evaluate the significance of Edward III's cleanliness mandate in 1349.

Pair & Share Activity

Q8. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Who had better public health, a Roman soldier or a Medieval monk?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

Carole Rawcliffe *argues: "Medieval towns were not entirely filthy; many had local laws requiring citizens to clean the street outside their house."*

Q9. How does Rawcliffe challenge the idea that all medieval towns were completely disgusting?

General Notes

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention the lack of sewers.
- Mention what people believed caused disease (miasma).

Q10. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why public health in towns got worse during the Middle Ages.

L3: To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?

(See Textbook Page 10)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Describe the sanitation problems in growing Tudor and Stuart towns.
- ☐ Explain why early flushing toilets like Sir John Harington's failed to catch on.
- ☐ Evaluate how Samuel Pepys's diary reveals the reality of Early Modern sanitation.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

Why were medieval towns dangerous for public health?

What was a Gongfermer?

Why did medieval monks build clean water systems?

What is a cesspit?

What did King Edward III order in 1357?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: ***conduit***

Q1. Identify who invented the first flushing water closet.

Q2. Why do you think this brilliant invention failed to catch on in Early Modern Britain despite its obvious sanitary benefits?

Q3. Describe the purpose of the New River project in 1613.

Q4. If you lived in the overcrowded, walled town of Tudor Portsmouth, what risks would you face from the lack of proper sewers and overflowing cesspits?

Q5. Explain what Samuel Pepys' diary reveals about Early Modern privies.

Q6. Evaluate the effectiveness of Early Modern water sellers for public health.

Pair & Share Activity

Q7. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why didn't Sir John Harington's flush toilet become popular instantly?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

Roy Porter *argues: "The rapid growth of London meant that traditional methods of waste disposal simply could not cope."*

Q8. What does Porter say was the main reason towns became so filthy?

General Notes

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention overcrowding.
- Mention the amount of waste produced.

Q9. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why the growth of towns (urbanisation) made public health worse in the Early Modern period.

L4: How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?

(See Textbook Page 13)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Describe the overcrowded and unhygienic conditions of industrial back-to-back housing.
- ☐ Explain how Edwin Chadwick argued for public health reform in his 1842 report.
- ☐ Evaluate Dr. John Snow's discovery that cholera was waterborne.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

Why did rivers in early modern towns become open sewers?

Who invented a working flushing toilet in 1596?

Why did Harington's flushing toilet fail to catch on for 250 years?

What does 'urbanisation' mean?

How did early modern townspeople get their drinking water?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

urbanization | cholera | epidemic | public health | laissez-faire

Rapid [. . . . .] meant cities grew too fast. The government believed in [. . . . .] , doing nothing to help. This led to a terrible [. . . . .] of [. . . . .] , forcing people to finally take [. . . . .] seriously.

Q1. Identify two effects of the industrial population surge on factory towns.

Q2. Describe the living conditions in industrial back-to-back housing.

Q3. Why did rapid population growth in places like Portsea make the 1849 cholera outbreak so devastating for the local community?

Q4. Explain how the cholera epidemics forced the government to act.

Q5. How did Dr. Snow use this map to challenge the prevailing 'miasma' theory of disease?

Q6. Evaluate the significance of Edwin Chadwick's 1842 report.

Pair & Share Activity

Q7. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was it fair for the government to follow a 'laissez-faire' attitude?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

Steven Johnson *argues: "John Snow's map of the Broad Street cholera outbreak was a triumph of medical detective work."*

Q8. Why does Johnson call Snow's work 'detective work'?

General Notes

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Explain what people used to believe (miasma).
- Explain what Snow proved about water.

Q9. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining why John Snow's discovery at the Broad Street pump was a turning point.

L5: Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?

(See Textbook Page 16)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Describe the events of the Great Stink in 1858.
- ☐ Explain how Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system transformed London.
- ☐ Evaluate how Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory revolutionized our understanding of disease.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

What was the 'laissez-faire' attitude?

What terrifying waterborne disease first struck Britain in 1831?

What scientific theory did doctors wrongly believe caused disease?

How did Dr. John Snow prove cholera was waterborne?

Who published a damning report on sanitary conditions in 1842?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

sewer | germ theory | sewage | civil engineering | infrastructure

Your Sentence:

Q1. Identify what John Snow's Broad Street map proved about cholera.

Q2. Describe the impact of the Great Stink on Parliament in 1858.

Q3. How did the construction of the Eastney Beam Engine House in 1887 solve the exact same public health crisis in Portsmouth that Bazalgette solved in London?

Q4. Explain how Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system solved London's waste problem.

Q5. What does the sheer scale of this brickwork reveal about the Victorian government's response to the Great Stink of 1858?

Q6. Explain the link between Louis Pasteur's Germ Theory and sanitation.

Q7. Evaluate the significance of the 1875 Public Health Act for modern sanitation.

Pair & Share Activity

Q8. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: What finally forced Parliament to act?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

> **Your Notes:**

Historian's Corner: Historian's Corner

The Observer Newspaper, 1861 *argues: "Bazalgette's sewer system was the most extensive and wonderful work of modern times."*

Q9. How did the media at the time view Bazalgette's sewers?

General Notes

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

Writing Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention the removal of sewage.
- Mention the end of cholera epidemics.

Q10. Write a PEEL paragraph explaining how Joseph Bazalgette's sewers improved public health in London.

L6: Assessment: Roman Public Health

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] To accurately sequence the key events of public health history.
- [ ] To evaluate the usefulness of primary sources for historical enquiries.

Chronological Domino Flowchart

Score: / 5

Task: *The historical events below are out of order. Read them carefully, then use your pen to* ***draw arrows connecting the boxes*** *in the correct chronological and causal order (Event A ➔ Event B ➔ Event C...).*

312 BC
Roman Aqueducts
The Romans begin building vast aqueducts and bathhouses.

1854
Broad Street Pump
John Snow proves cholera is waterborne.

1348
The Black Death
The plague kills a third of England, blamed on miasma.

1858
The Great Stink
The Thames smells so bad that Parliament shuts down, leading to Bazalgette's sewers.

1842
Chadwick's Report
Edwin Chadwick publishes his report on sanitary conditions.

Q1. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into Roman public health and bathhouses?

[8 marks • 10 mins]

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

General Notes

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

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